

How This Deck Works

Universal Design for Learning · Multi-Tiered System of Supports

EVERY LEARNER · SAME FIRM GOAL

Multiple ways in

Every lesson opens with a real question and a clear “I can” goal, so you know why it matters and where you’re headed.

Multiple ways to see it

Direct instruction, primary sources, maps, and bilingual key vocabulary — the same ideas shown more than one way.

Multiple ways to show it

Model-with-me, sentence frames, and choices in how you respond — you reach the same goal by the route that works for you.

*Your teacher checks your progress along the way and gives you another path if you need one — **the goal never lowers.***

US.08 Social Darwinism & Social Gospel

TN STANDARD

US.08 – Explain the concepts of Social Darwinism and the Social Gospel.

I CAN

I can explain the concepts of Social Darwinism and the Social Gospel and how they shaped debates over government's role in addressing social problems.

Social Darwinism applied “survival of the fittest” to society — Spencer and Sumner used it to defend industrial wealth and oppose helping the poor.

ZOOM IN



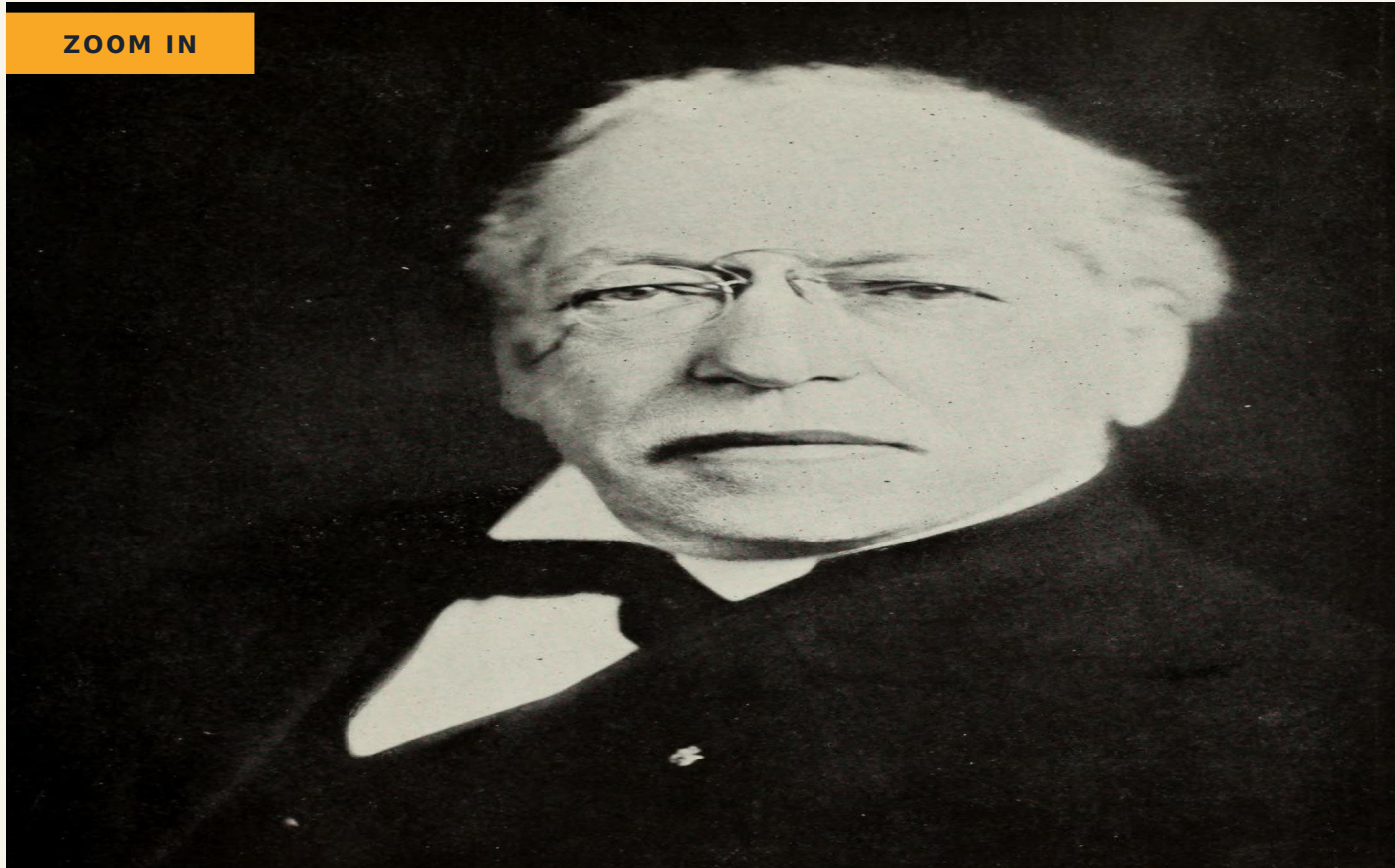
The Social Gospel answered back — reformers like Rauschenbusch argued Christian ethics demanded fighting poverty and improving working conditions.

ZOOM IN



These rival philosophies framed the era's central debate: should government stay out of social problems, or act to reduce inequality?

ZOOM IN



US.08 · Cultural & Economic Impact

Carnegie explained how the rich should use their fortunes — read “The Gospel of Wealth” and weigh who he thinks deserves help.

WHO

Andrew Carnegie, America's wealthiest steel manufacturer.

WHEN

1889, at the height of the Gilded Age and rising labor unrest.

WHY

A wealthy author writing about wealth reveals assumptions about who deserves help — and who does not.

The Gospel of Wealth

Andrew Carnegie · 1889

"The problem of our age is the proper administration of wealth, so that the ties of brotherhood may still bind together the rich and poor in harmonious relationship. The conditions of human life have not only been changed, but revolutionized, within the past few hundred years... The contrast between the palace of the millionaire and the cottage of the laborer... measures the change which has come with civilization."

[Carnegie Corporation of New York](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.08:

Industrialists and defenders of laissez-faire, who used Social Darwinism to justify vast fortunes and resist regulation or relief.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.08:

The urban poor and working class, dismissed as “unfit” by Social Darwinists — the very people the Social Gospel and settlement houses tried to aid.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.08:

Private thinkers and philanthropists (Spencer, Sumner, Carnegie, Rauschenbusch) shaping public opinion — government had not yet claimed a role in social welfare.

Anchor: Carnegie, “The Gospel of Wealth,” 1889 (Carnegie Corporation of New York)

Words you need before we read

Social Darwinism

En español: *Darwinismo Social*

WHAT IT MEANS

The belief that Darwin's theory of natural selection applies to human society — the wealthy are 'fit' and the poor are 'weak,' justifying laissez-faire capitalism and opposing government aid.

Social Gospel

En español: *Evangelio Social*

WHAT IT MEANS

A religious movement that emphasized Christians' duty to address poverty, unsafe conditions, and inequality — providing moral foundation for Progressive Era reform.

Settlement House

En español: *Casa de Asentamiento*

WHAT IT MEANS

Community centers in poor urban neighborhoods staffed by reformers who provided services such as childcare, education, and job training to immigrants and the poor.

Check your understanding

Analyze how these competing philosophies shaped debates over government's role in addressing social and economic problems.

- A** Social Darwinism argued government should not interfere while Social Gospel supported intervention, creating a fundamental tension about whether society should address inequality that continues today
- B** Both philosophies supported the same policies, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research
- C** Neither philosophy influenced government policy, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D** Government ignored both viewpoints, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.09

Booker T. Washington vs W.E.B. Du Bois

TN STANDARD

US.09 – Compare and contrast the ideas and philosophies of Booker T. Washington and W.E.B. Du Bois. (TCA)

I CAN

I can compare and contrast the ideas and philosophies of Booker T. Washington and W.E.B. Du Bois regarding education, civil rights, and strategies for African American advancement.

Booker T. Washington — born enslaved, founder of Tuskegee — became the most prominent Black leader after his 1895 Atlanta Compromise speech.

ZOOM IN



Washington emphasized vocational training and economic self-sufficiency; Du Bois demanded a liberal-arts education for a “Talented Tenth” of leaders.

ZOOM IN



Washington favored accommodation and gradualism; Du Bois rejected it, co-founding the NAACP to demand full civil and political rights now.

ZOOM IN



Read Washington's own words at Atlanta — then ask what he accepted, and why his audience mattered.

WHO

Booker T. Washington — formerly enslaved educator, founder of Tuskegee Institute.

WHEN

1895, thirty years after the Civil War, in the era of Jim Crow laws and rising racial violence.

WHY

Context matters — his audience included Southern white leaders who controlled access to Black economic opportunity.

Atlanta Compromise Speech

Booker T. Washington · 1895

"In all things that are purely social we can be as separate as the fingers, yet one as the hand in all things essential to mutual progress. There is no defense or security for any of us except in the highest intelligence and development of all... The wisest among my race understand that the agitation of questions of social equality is the extremest folly."

[History Matters, George Mason University](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.09:

Southern white leaders reassured by Washington's accommodation; and Black communities who gained trade skills and institutions like Tuskegee.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.09:

African Americans denied full political and civil rights under Jim Crow — the delay Du Bois warned accommodation would prolong.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.09:

Two Black leaders defining rival strategies — Washington through Tuskegee and public accommodation, Du Bois through the NAACP and protest.

Anchor: Washington, Atlanta Compromise Speech, 1895 (History Matters, GMU)

Words you need before we read

Booker T. Washington

En español: *Booker T. Washington*

WHAT IT MEANS

African American educator who founded Tuskegee Institute and advocated vocational training and economic self-sufficiency as the path to African American advancement, accepting temporary segregation.

W.E.B. Du Bois

En español: *W.E.B. Du Bois*

WHAT IT MEANS

African American scholar who demanded immediate civil and political rights, co-founded the NAACP, and advocated classical education for the 'Talented Tenth' of African American leaders.

Atlanta Compromise

En español: *Compromiso de Atlanta*

WHAT IT MEANS

Booker T. Washington's 1895 speech accepting racial segregation in exchange for economic opportunity, arguing African Americans should focus on industrial skills rather than political rights.

Check your understanding

Evaluate which approach was more effective for advancing African American progress during this era.

- A** Washington's approach completely succeeded, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- B** Both contributed: Washington built institutions and economic opportunity while Du Bois established organizations like the NAACP that would lead later civil rights victories—different strategies served different needs
- C** Neither approach had any impact, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- D** Du Bois's approach achieved everything during his lifetime, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.10

Populism & Granger Movement

TN STANDARD

US.10 – Explain the characteristics and impact of the Granger movement and populism, emphasizing the conflicts between farmers and the railroads.

I CAN

I can explain the characteristics and impact of the Granger movement and populism, emphasizing the conflicts between farmers and the railroads.

Populism gave farmers and rural workers a political voice against banks, railroads, and eastern financial power.

ZOOM IN

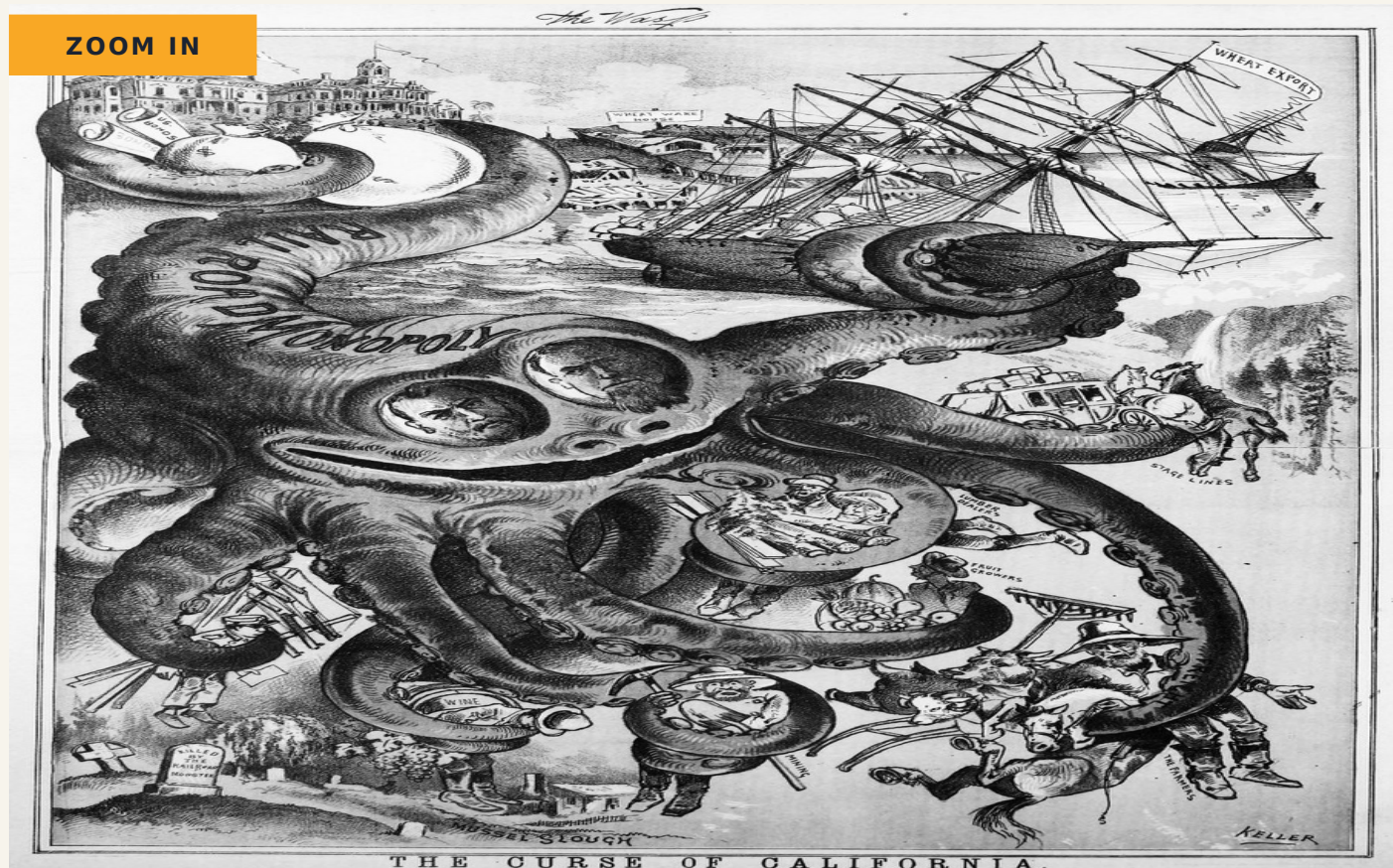


The Grange (1867) and the Farmers' Alliance organized farmers socially and politically — lobbying for railroad regulation.



Railroads squeezed farmers with high, discriminatory freight rates, rebates to big shippers, and control of grain elevators.

ZOOM IN



Read the 1892 Populist Platform — its demands reveal what farmers thought was broken and how they wanted to fix it.

WHO

The People's Party — delegates representing millions of American farmers from the South and Midwest.

WHEN

1892, during a severe agricultural depression with falling crop prices and rising railroad costs.

WHY

Political platforms reveal what a group believes is wrong and what power they want to use to fix it.

Populist Party Platform

People's Party National Convention · 1892

"We demand free and unlimited coinage of silver and gold at the present legal ratio of 16 to 1... We demand a graduated income tax... We believe that the power of government—in other words, of the people—should be expanded... to the end that oppression, injustice, and poverty shall eventually cease in the land."

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.10:

Railroads, banks, and eastern financiers who profited from high rates, tight money, and the gold standard.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.10:

Farmers crushed by falling crop prices, debt, and freight charges — the constituency Populism organized to defend.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.10:

The People's Party and Farmers' Alliance building a mass movement, and the courts and Congress that would later address railroad regulation.

Anchor: Populist Party Platform, 1892 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Populism

En español: *Populismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A political movement representing the interests of ordinary farmers and workers against the power of banks, railroads, and wealthy eastern interests in the late 19th century.

Granger Movement

En español: *Movimiento Granger*

WHAT IT MEANS

A farmers' organization founded in the 1860s–1870s that provided social support and lobbied for railroad regulation; won early 'Granger laws' capping freight rates.

Farmers' Alliance

En español: *Alianza de Agricultores*

WHAT IT MEANS

A coalition of farmers' organizations in the 1870s–1890s that created cooperatives, lobbied for government credit, and laid the groundwork for the Populist Party.

Check your understanding

Analyze why the Populist movement ultimately failed but influenced later Progressive reforms.

- A** Populism had no lasting influence, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research
- B** Populism succeeded in all its goals immediately, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- C** The movement failed electorally when Bryan lost in 1896, but its ideas—income tax, direct election of senators, railroad regulation—were adopted by Progressives, showing how failed movements can shape future reform
- D** Progressive reforms were unrelated to Populism, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.11

Rise of the Labor Movement

TN STANDARD

US.11 – Explain the rise of the labor movement, union tactics (e.g. strikes), the role of leaders (e.g. Eugene Debs and Samuel Gompers), the unjust use of prison labor (e.g. Coal Creek labor saga), and the responses of management and government.

I CAN

I can explain the rise of the labor movement, union tactics such as strikes, the role of leaders such as Eugene Debs and Samuel Gompers, the unjust use of prison labor (Coal Creek), and the responses of management and government.

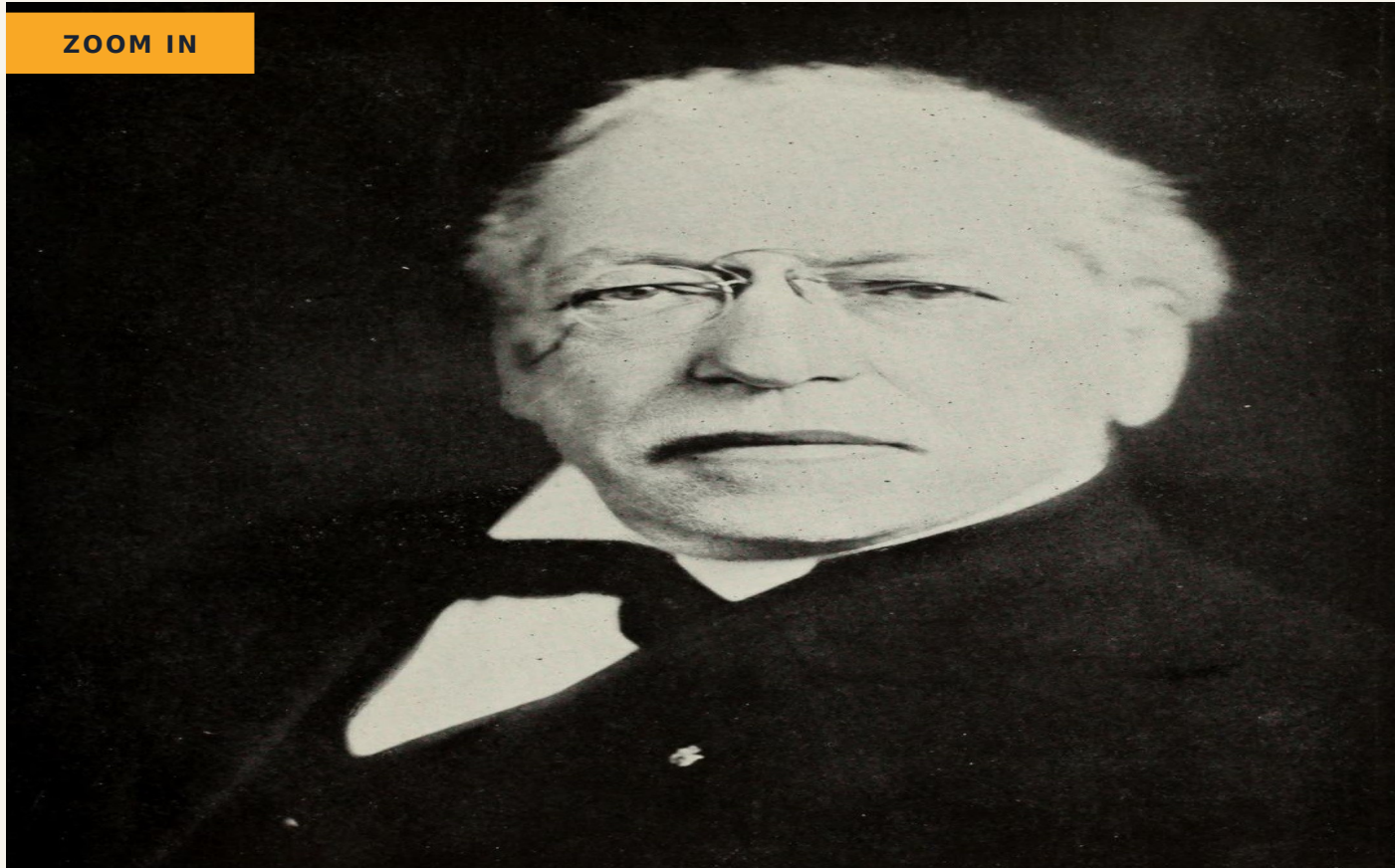
Brutal conditions — 12-16 hour days, dangerous work, child labor, and wages cut at will — drove industrial workers to organize.



US.11 · Factors Leading to Organization

Unions bargained collectively and used strikes to force negotiation; leaders included AFL's Samuel Gompers and socialist Eugene Debs.

ZOOM IN



In Tennessee's Coal Creek saga (1891), miners revolted against convict-lease labor — prisoners leased as unpaid forced workers.

ZOOM IN



Management fought back with lockouts, Pinkertons, blacklisting, and court injunctions — often with government backing.

ZOOM IN



Read Gompers's "What Does Labor Want?" — his words reveal what the movement believed the country owed its workers.

WHO

Samuel Gompers, AFL president and chief voice of organized labor in America.

WHEN

1893, during the worst economic depression of the 19th century (the Panic of 1893).

WHY

A labor leader's public speech reveals what workers needed — and what the movement believed the country owed its workers.

Samuel Gompers Address

Samuel Gompers, AFL President · 1893

"What does labor want? We want more schoolhouses and less jails; more books and less arsenals; more learning and less vice; more leisure and less greed; more justice and less revenge; in fact, more of the opportunities to cultivate our better natures, to make manhood more noble, womanhood more beautiful, and childhood more happy and bright."

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.11:

Industrialists who kept wages low and used lockouts, strikebreakers, and convict labor to blunt worker organizing.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.11:

Workers facing dangerous conditions and cut wages; leased convicts forced into unpaid mine labor at Coal Creek.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.11:

Union leaders like Gompers and Debs; employers and Pinkertons; and courts and government that often intervened on management's side.

Anchor: Gompers, "What Does Labor Want?" 1893 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Labor Union

En español: *Sindicato Laboral*

WHAT IT MEANS

An organization of workers formed to protect their rights and improve wages, hours, and working conditions through collective bargaining and, if necessary, strikes.

Strike

En español: *Huelga*

WHAT IT MEANS

A work stoppage organized by union workers to pressure management to meet their demands for better wages, hours, or working conditions.

Collective Bargaining

En español: *Negociación Colectiva*

WHAT IT MEANS

The process where union representatives negotiate wages, hours, and conditions on behalf of all workers, giving workers more power than they would have bargaining individually.

Check your understanding

Analyze why government and business leaders often opposed labor unions and used force to break strikes.

- A** Business and government supported all union activities, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which does not align with the documented historical record, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- B** Government remained neutral in all labor disputes, but the historical record tells a more complex story, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- C** Unions never faced any opposition, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- D** Unions threatened corporate profits and control, so owners used strikebreakers and private security while government deployed troops and injunctions, viewing organized labor as dangerous to economic and social order

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.12

Trusts, Monopolies & Antitrust

TN STANDARD

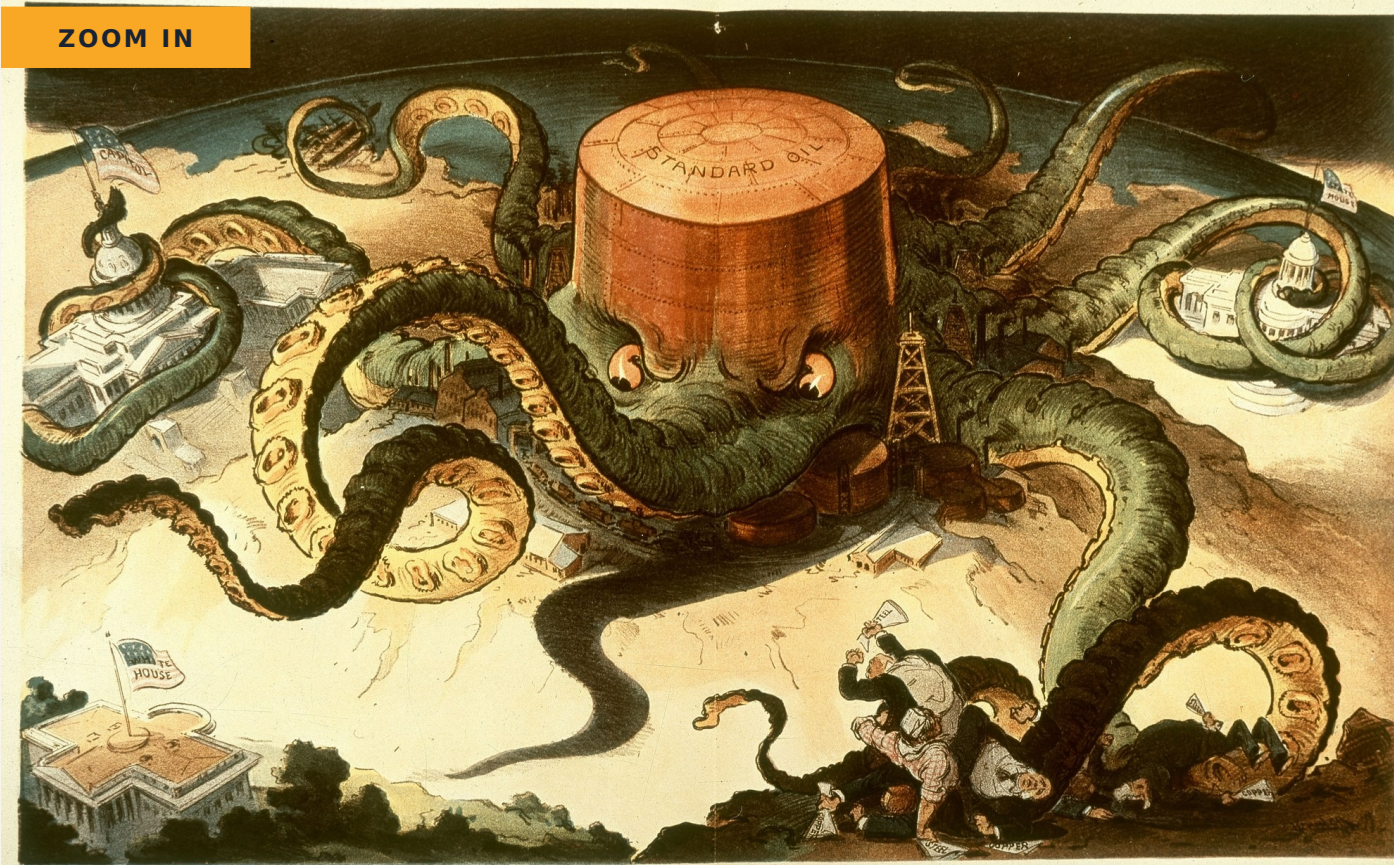
US.12 – Describe the rise of trusts and monopolies, their impact on consumers and workers, and the government's response, including the Sherman Antitrust Act of 1890 and the Clayton Antitrust Act of 1914.

I CAN

I can describe the rise of trusts and monopolies, their impact on consumers and workers, and the government's response including the Sherman Antitrust Act (1890) and the Clayton Antitrust Act (1914).

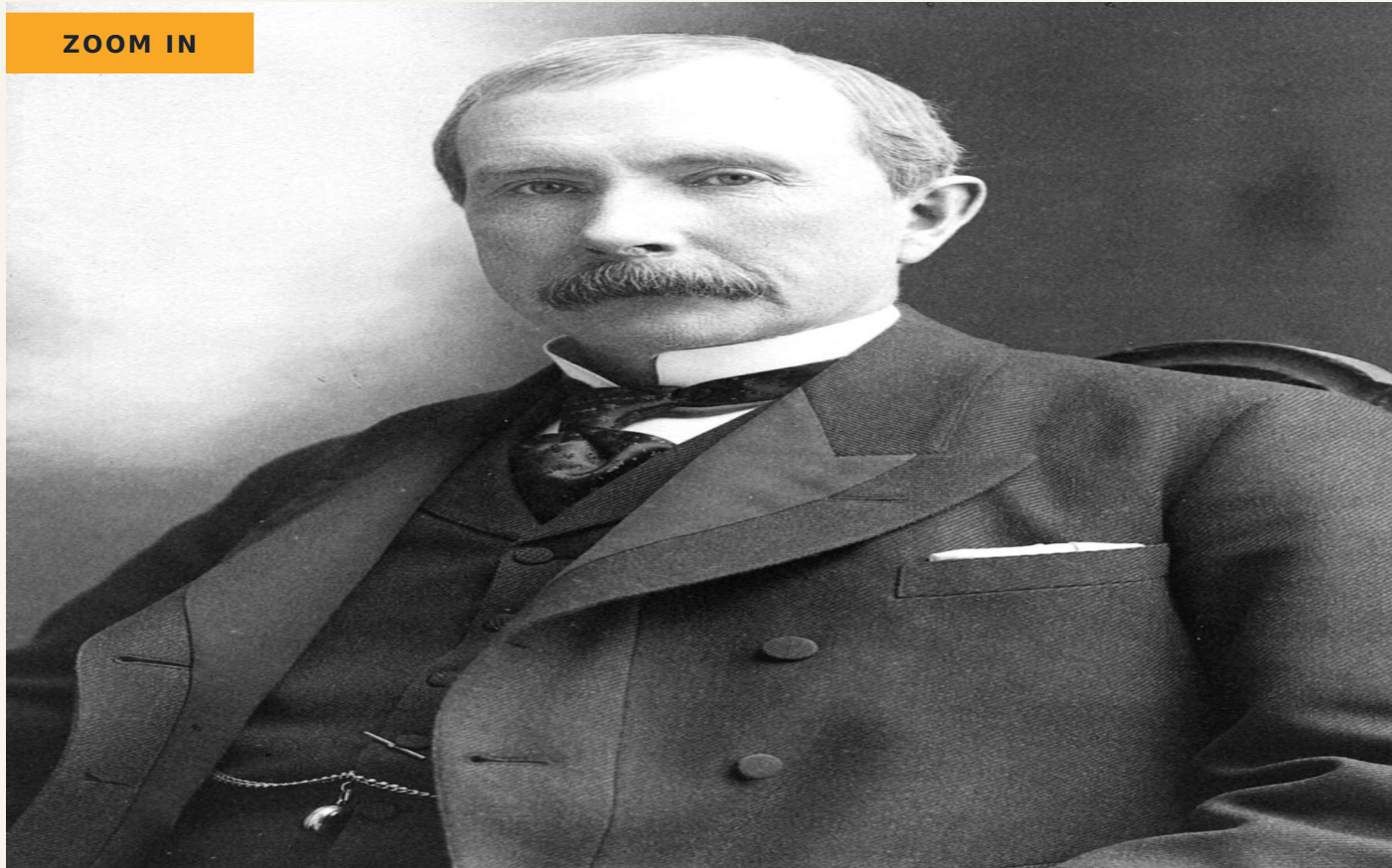
**Trusts let a board of trustees control an entire industry —
Rockefeller's Standard Oil refined 90% of America's oil.**

ZOOM IN



Monopolies raised consumer prices and used predatory pricing to crush smaller competitors and suppress wages.

ZOOM IN



US.12 · Impact on Consumers, Workers & Competition

The Sherman Antitrust Act (1890) outlawed “restraint of trade,” and the Clayton Act (1914) closed loopholes — banning price discrimination and protecting unions.



Read the Sherman Antitrust Act itself — the law's wording reveals what Congress believed monopolies were doing to America.

WHO

U.S. Congress — a federal statute signed into law by President Harrison.

WHEN

1890, as Standard Oil controlled 90% of American oil refining and trusts dominated steel, sugar, and tobacco.

WHY

Federal laws reveal what Congress believed needed government protection — ask what harm they were trying to prevent.

Sherman Antitrust Act

U.S. Congress · 1890

"Every contract, combination in the form of trust or otherwise, or conspiracy, in restraint of trade or commerce among the several States, or with foreign nations, is declared to be illegal... Every person who shall monopolize, or attempt to monopolize... any part of the trade or commerce among the several States... shall be deemed guilty of a felony."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.12:

Trust owners like Rockefeller who dominated industries and drove out rivals before regulation caught up.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.12:

Consumers paying monopoly prices, workers with suppressed wages, and small competitors destroyed by predatory pricing.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.12:

The U.S. Congress, which passed the Sherman (1890) and Clayton (1914) Acts, and courts that interpreted “restraint of trade.”

Anchor: Sherman Antitrust Act, 1890 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Trust

En español: *Trust (Fideicomiso)*

WHAT IT MEANS

A legal arrangement where stockholders in several companies transfer their shares to a central board, creating a single entity that controls an entire industry and eliminates competition.

Monopoly

En español: *Monopolio*

WHAT IT MEANS

Complete control of a product or service by a single company, allowing it to set prices without competition — harmful to consumers, workers, and smaller businesses.

Sherman Antitrust Act

En español: *Ley Sherman Antimonopolio*

WHAT IT MEANS

An 1890 federal law that made it illegal to form trusts, monopolies, or conspiracies that restrained trade — the first federal law to regulate corporate power.

Check your understanding

Evaluate whether the Clayton Antitrust Act of 1914 successfully addressed the limitations of earlier antitrust legislation.

- A** By specifying illegal practices, exempting labor unions, and creating the FTC for enforcement, the Clayton Act improved antitrust effectiveness, though success still depended on political will to enforce it
- B** The Clayton Act was identical to the Sherman Act, which represents a common misconception about the period and fails to account for key developments in the broader context, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- C** The Clayton Act weakened antitrust enforcement, which represents a common misconception about the period, which represents a common misconception about this historical period and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D** Antitrust laws had no impact on business practices, but the historical record tells a more complex story, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.13

Working Conditions, Women & Child Labor

TN STANDARD

US.13 – Describe working conditions in industries during this era, including the use of labor by women and children.

I CAN

I can describe working conditions in industries during this era, including the use of labor by women and children.

Industrial workers endured 10-16 hour days, six or seven days a week, with no overtime, sick leave, or compensation for injury.



US.13 · Industrial Working Conditions

Women filled garment, textile, and food-processing jobs — paid far less than men for the same work.

KEY POINT

Women filled garment, textile, and food-processing jobs — paid far less than men for the same work.

An estimated 1.75 million children under 15 worked in mines, mills, and factories — losing schooling and safety.

ZOOM IN



The Triangle Shirtwaist fire (1911) killed 146 workers — mostly young immigrant women — behind locked exits, forcing safety reform.



US.13 · The Triangle Shirtwaist Fire

Read survivor Rose Safran's account of the fire — then ask what a witness could see, and what she could not know.

WHO

Rose Safran — a young immigrant worker who survived the Triangle fire.

WHEN

1911, weeks after the fire; she is testifying about what she witnessed firsthand.

WHY

Survivor testimony is powerful primary evidence — but always ask: what could this witness see, and what might they not know?

Triangle Shirtwaist Factory Fire Survivor Account

Rose Safran · 1911

"The door was locked and immediately there was a great jam of girls behind me... I stood there crying and praying while some girls jumped from the window ledge. They went through the air like bundles. I knew that if the door was not opened I would die on the window ledge or be pushed off. The whole thing was over in seven minutes."

[Cornell University ILR School](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.13:

Factory owners who cut costs through cheap female and child labor and minimal safety spending.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.13:

Women paid less than men, children denied schooling, and the 146 Triangle workers who died behind locked doors.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.13:

Employers who set conditions; and, after the fire, city and state governments that enacted new factory-safety laws.

Anchor: Rose Safran, Triangle fire survivor account, 1911 (Cornell ILR)

Words you need before we read

Sweatshop

En español: *Taller de Explotación*

WHAT IT MEANS

A factory or workshop where workers faced long hours, low wages, and dangerous or unhealthy conditions — common in the garment industry employing immigrant women.

Child Labor

En español: *Trabajo Infantil*

WHAT IT MEANS

The employment of children — sometimes as young as 5 or 6 — in factories, mines, and mills; an estimated 1.75 million children worked in American industry by 1900.

Triangle Shirtwaist Fire

En español: *Incendio de la Fábrica Triangle*

WHAT IT MEANS

A 1911 factory fire in New York City that killed 146 workers — mostly young immigrant women — trapped by locked exits, becoming a catalyst for worker safety reform.

Check your understanding

Analyze how tragedies like the Triangle Shirtwaist Factory Fire led to workplace safety reforms.

- A** The fire had no impact on workplace safety, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- B** The deaths of 146 workers from locked exits, inadequate fire safety, and collapsed fire escapes shocked the public and led to fire codes, factory inspections, and workers' compensation laws
- C** Workplace safety was already adequate before the fire, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- D** Reforms only affected the garment industry, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.14

Muckrakers & Progressive Idealists

TN STANDARD

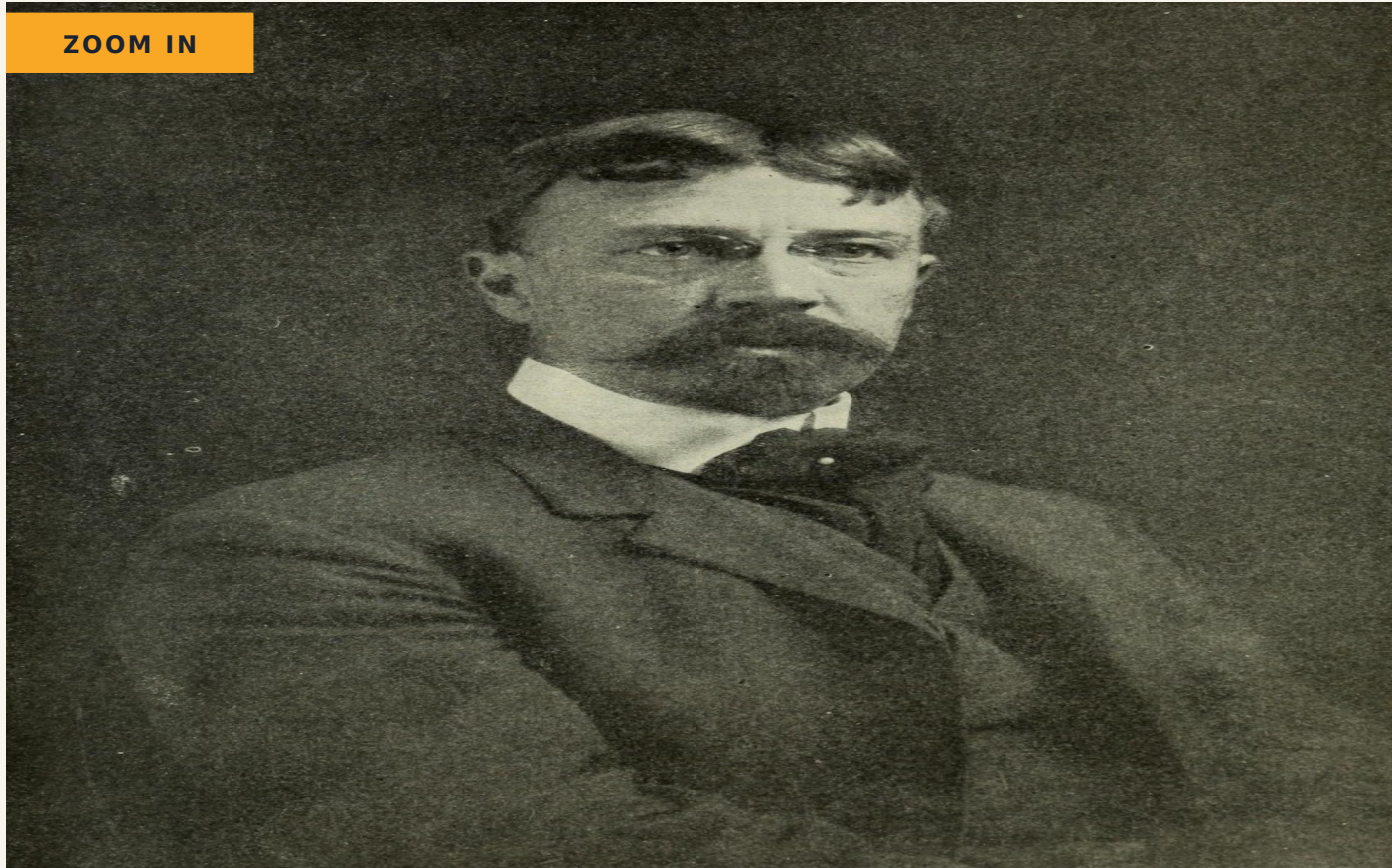
US.14 – Explain the roles played by muckrakers and progressive idealists, including: Robert M. La Follette, Sr., President Theodore Roosevelt, Upton Sinclair, Lincoln Steffens, Ida Tarbell.

I CAN

I can explain the roles played by muckrakers and progressive idealists, including Robert M. La Follette Sr., President Theodore Roosevelt, Upton Sinclair, Lincoln Steffens, and Ida Tarbell.

Muckrakers — named by Roosevelt — were investigative journalists who exposed corruption, corporate abuse, and social injustice.

ZOOM IN



“Fighting Bob” La Follette made Wisconsin the “laboratory of democracy,” pioneering primaries, regulation, and expert governance.

ZOOM IN



US.14 · La Follette & the Wisconsin Idea

Steffens's "Shame of the Cities" exposed machine corruption; Tarbell's Standard Oil series documented Rockefeller's ruthless tactics.

ZOOM IN



Sinclair's "The Jungle" (1906) exposed meatpacking horrors — prompting Roosevelt to back federal food-safety laws.

ZOOM IN



Read Tarbell on Standard Oil — then weigh her direct evidence against the fact that Rockefeller ruined her father’s business.

WHO

Ida Tarbell — investigative journalist, daughter of a Pennsylvania oil producer destroyed by Standard Oil.

WHEN

1904, after two years of documentary investigation; Standard Oil was at the height of its power.

WHY

The author's personal connection to the subject raises both credibility (direct experience) and a question: does her family's loss make her biased? A good historian acknowledges both.

The History of the Standard Oil Company

Ida Tarbell · 1904

"Mr. Rockefeller has systematically played with loaded dice, and it is doubtful if there has ever been a time since 1872 when he has run a race with a competitor and started fair. Business played in this way loses all its sportmanlike qualities. It is fit only for tricksters."

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.14:

The reading public, who gained hard evidence of abuse; reformers who used muckraking exposes to build support for regulation.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.14:

Corrupt bosses and trusts exposed by name — Standard Oil, municipal machines, and meatpackers forced into the public eye.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.14:

Journalists (Tarbell, Steffens, Sinclair) and reform leaders (La Follette, Roosevelt) who turned exposure into policy.

Anchor: Tarbell, The History of the Standard Oil Company, 1904 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Muckraker

En español: *Periodista de Investigación*

WHAT IT MEANS

Investigative journalists and authors who exposed corporate abuse, government corruption, and social injustice in the Progressive Era, building public pressure for reform.

Progressive Movement

En español: *Movimiento Progresivo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A broad reform effort (1890s–1920s) that used journalism, legislation, and political organizing to address the social and economic harms of industrialization.

Wisconsin Idea

En español: *Idea de Wisconsin*

WHAT IT MEANS

Robert La Follette's model of Progressive reform using university experts to design legislation and regulate corporations, making Wisconsin 'the laboratory of democracy.'

Check your understanding

Evaluate Theodore Roosevelt's complex relationship with muckrakers and his role in progressive reform.

- A** Roosevelt completely supported all muckrakers, which does not reflect the consensus among historians, which does not align with the documented historical record and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- B** Roosevelt opposed all muckraking journalism, which represents a common misconception about the period, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C** Roosevelt used muckraker exposés to build support for reforms like consumer protection and trust-busting, but also criticized excessive negativity—showing how reform leaders balance media pressure with political strategy
- D** Muckrakers and Roosevelt had no connection, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality, which represents a common misconception about this historical period

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.15

Progressive Movement Goals & Achievements

TN STANDARD

US.15 – Analyze the goals and achievements of the Progressive movement, including: Adoption of the initiative, referendum, and recall, Adoption of the primary system, 16th Amendment, 17th Amendment, 18th Amendment.

I CAN

I can analyze the goals and achievements of the Progressive movement, including the initiative, referendum, recall, direct primary, 16th Amendment, 17th Amendment, and 18th Amendment.

Progressives sought to use government power to curb corporate trusts, protect workers and consumers, and clean up politics.



US.15 · Goals of the Progressive Movement

Initiative, referendum, and recall gave voters direct power to propose laws, approve them, and remove officials.

ZOOM IN



US.15 · Initiative, Referendum & Recall

The direct primary took candidate selection away from party bosses and gave it to voters.

ZOOM IN



Three amendments: the 16th (income tax), 17th (direct election of senators), and 18th (Prohibition) enshrined Progressive goals.

KEY POINT

Three amendments: the 16th (income tax), 17th (direct election of senators), and 18th (Prohibition) enshrined Progressive goals.

Read the 16th Amendment — a single sentence that reshaped federal power. Ask what problem the income tax was solving.

WHO

The U.S. Congress and state ratifying conventions — the constitutional amendment process.

WHEN

1913, after decades of Progressive lobbying for a federal income tax.

WHY

Constitutional amendments reveal what a society agreed was important enough to change the fundamental law — ask what problem it was solving.

16th Amendment

U.S. Constitution · 1913

"The Congress shall have power to lay and collect taxes on incomes, from whatever source derived, without apportionment among the several States, and without regard to any census or enumeration."

[Constitution Annotated, Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.15:

Ordinary voters gaining direct democratic tools; the federal government gaining a stable income-tax revenue base.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.15:

Party bosses who lost control of nominations; wealthy interests newly subject to a federal income tax.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.15:

State legislatures and Congress, which adopted direct-democracy reforms and ratified the 16th, 17th, and 18th Amendments.

Anchor: 16th Amendment, 1913 (Constitution Annotated, Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Initiative

En español: *Iniciativa*

WHAT IT MEANS

A Progressive reform allowing citizens to propose new laws by collecting enough voter signatures to put the proposal directly on the ballot.

Referendum

En español: *Referéndum*

WHAT IT MEANS

A Progressive reform allowing voters to approve or reject laws passed by the state legislature — giving citizens a direct check on legislative power.

Recall

En español: *Revocación*

WHAT IT MEANS

A Progressive reform allowing voters to remove elected officials from office before their terms expire — a direct accountability tool against corrupt or unresponsive officials.

Check your understanding

Analyze which Progressive reforms had the most lasting impact on American democracy.

- A** No Progressive reforms survived, which represents a common misconception about the period, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- B** Only Prohibition had lasting impact, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- C** Progressive reforms were all reversed, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources
- D** Direct primaries, direct election of senators, and the income tax fundamentally reshaped American politics and remain in effect, while Prohibition demonstrated that not all reforms succeed

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.16

Theodore Roosevelt's Progressive Achievements

TN STANDARD

US.16 – Analyze the significant progressive achievements during President Theodore Roosevelt's administration, including: Square Deal, 'Trust-busting', Pure Food and Drug Act, Meat Inspection Act, Support for conservation.

I CAN

I can analyze the significant progressive achievements during President Theodore Roosevelt's administration, including the Square Deal, trust-busting, Pure Food and Drug Act, Meat Inspection Act, and conservation efforts.

Roosevelt's "Square Deal" promised fair treatment for labor, business, and consumers alike.

ZOOM IN



After “The Jungle,” Roosevelt backed the Pure Food and Drug Act and Meat Inspection Act (1906) to protect consumers.

ZOOM IN

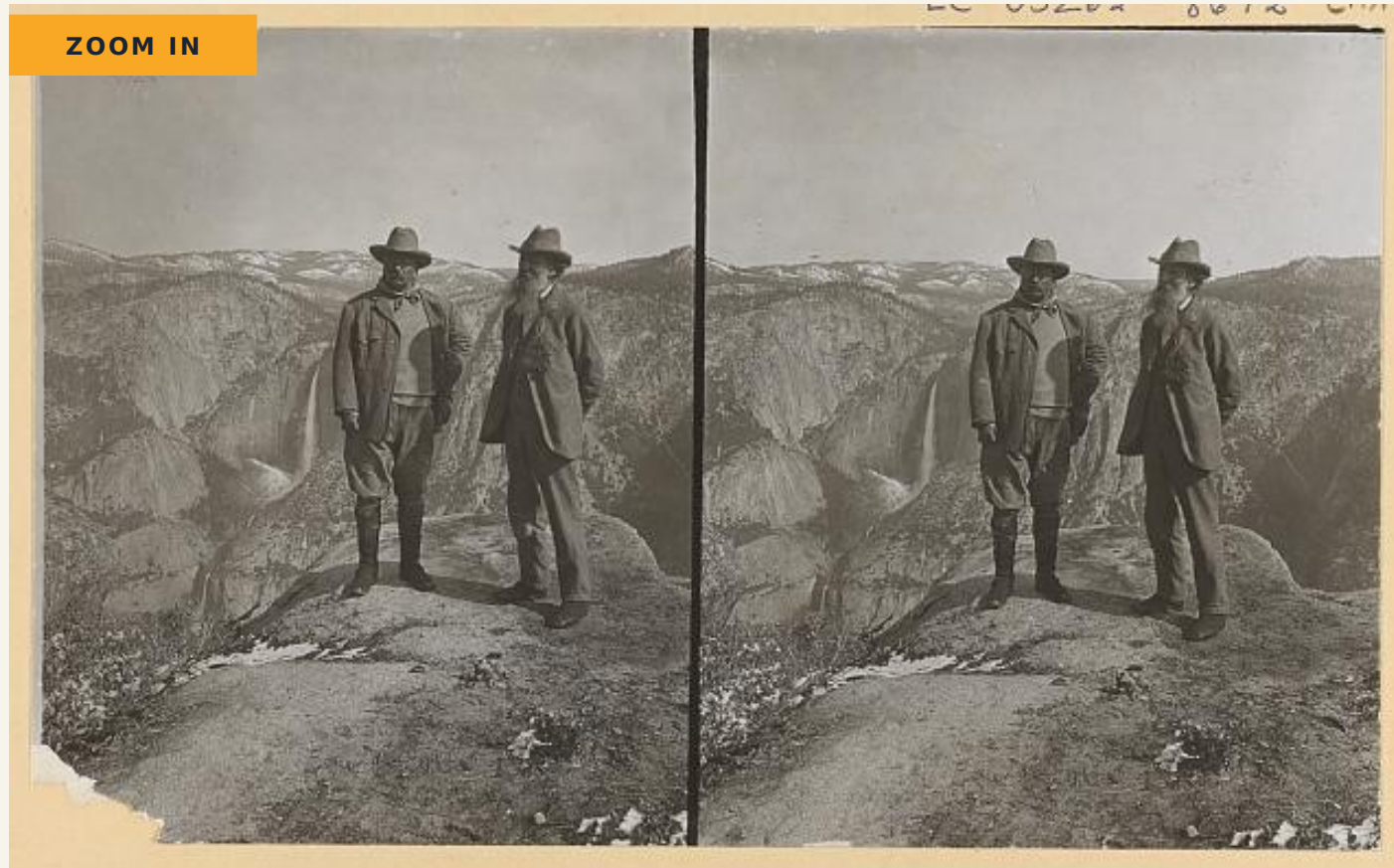


US.16 · Pure Food & Meat Inspection Acts

As a “trust-buster,” Roosevelt filed 44 antitrust suits — including against Standard Oil — to check corporate power.



The first environmentalist president, Roosevelt protected some 230 million acres — 150 national forests and 5 national parks.



Read Roosevelt's "Square Deal" speech — ask which group he reassures and which he challenges.

WHO

Theodore Roosevelt — 26th President of the United States, speaking as commander in chief.

WHEN

1903, in the middle of a national coal strike and rising public anger at corporate trusts.

WHY

A president's public speech defines policy for millions of people — ask what group he is trying to reassure, and what group he may be challenging.

Square Deal Speech

President Theodore Roosevelt · 1903

"When I say I believe in a square deal I do not mean... to give every man the best hand. If the cards do not come to any man, or if they do come, and he has not got the power to play them, that is his affair. All I mean is that there shall be no crookedness in the dealing."

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.16:

Consumers protected by food-safety laws; the public whose lands were conserved; workers given a fairer hearing under the Square Deal.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.16:

Monopoly trusts targeted by 44 antitrust suits; meatpackers and industries newly subject to federal inspection and regulation.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.16:

President Theodore Roosevelt and his administration, using executive power, antitrust suits, and Congress to enact reform.

Anchor: Roosevelt, Square Deal Speech, 1903 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Square Deal

En español: *Trato Justo*

WHAT IT MEANS

Theodore Roosevelt's domestic policy promising fair treatment for all Americans — balancing the interests of consumers, workers, and businesses through federal regulation.

Trust-Busting

En español: *Disolución de Trusts*

WHAT IT MEANS

Roosevelt's aggressive use of the Sherman Antitrust Act to break up monopolistic corporations — he filed 44 antitrust suits, earning the nickname 'trust-buster.'

Conservation

En español: *Conservación*

WHAT IT MEANS

The protection and sustainable management of natural resources; Roosevelt established 150 national forests and 5 national parks, protecting 230 million acres of public land.

Check your understanding

Evaluate Roosevelt's conservation legacy and its impact on environmental policy.

- A** By creating national parks, forests, and wildlife refuges while balancing development with preservation, Roosevelt established conservation as a federal responsibility with lasting impact on American environmental policy
- B** Roosevelt opposed conservation, but the historical record tells a more complex story, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research
- C** Conservation was unimportant to Roosevelt, which represents a common misconception about the period and fails to account for key developments in the broader context and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- D** His conservation policies were all reversed, but the historical record tells a more complex story and fails to account for key developments in the broader context and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.17

Woodrow Wilson's Progressive Achievements

TN STANDARD

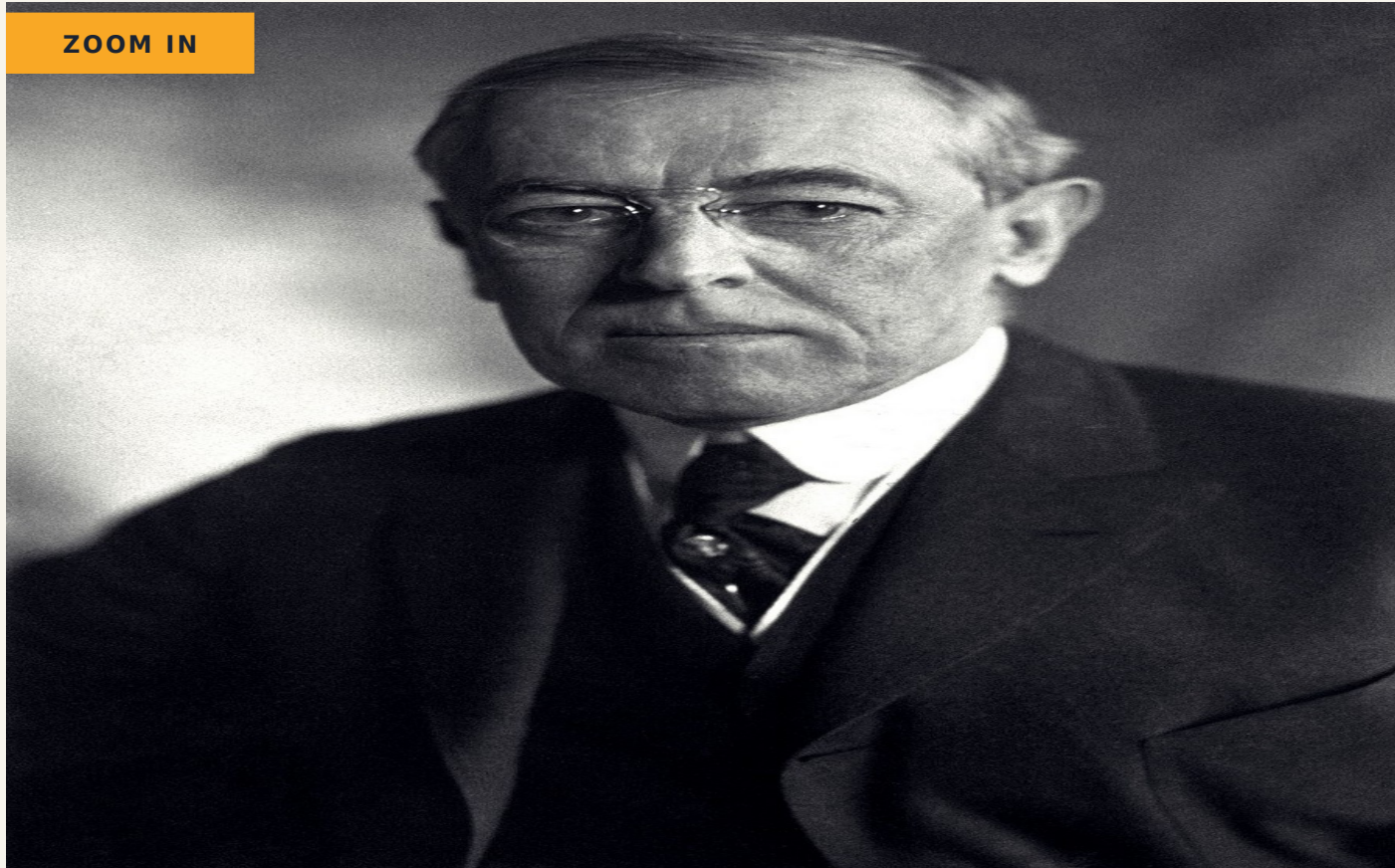
US.17 – Analyze the significant progressive achievements during President Woodrow Wilson's administration, including: the New Freedom, the Federal Reserve Act, and the creation of the National Park Service.

I CAN

I can analyze the significant progressive achievements during President Woodrow Wilson's administration, including the New Freedom, the Federal Reserve Act, and the creation of the National Park Service.

Wilson won the 1912 three-way race and pushed his “New Freedom” — attacking trusts, tariffs, and high finance.

ZOOM IN



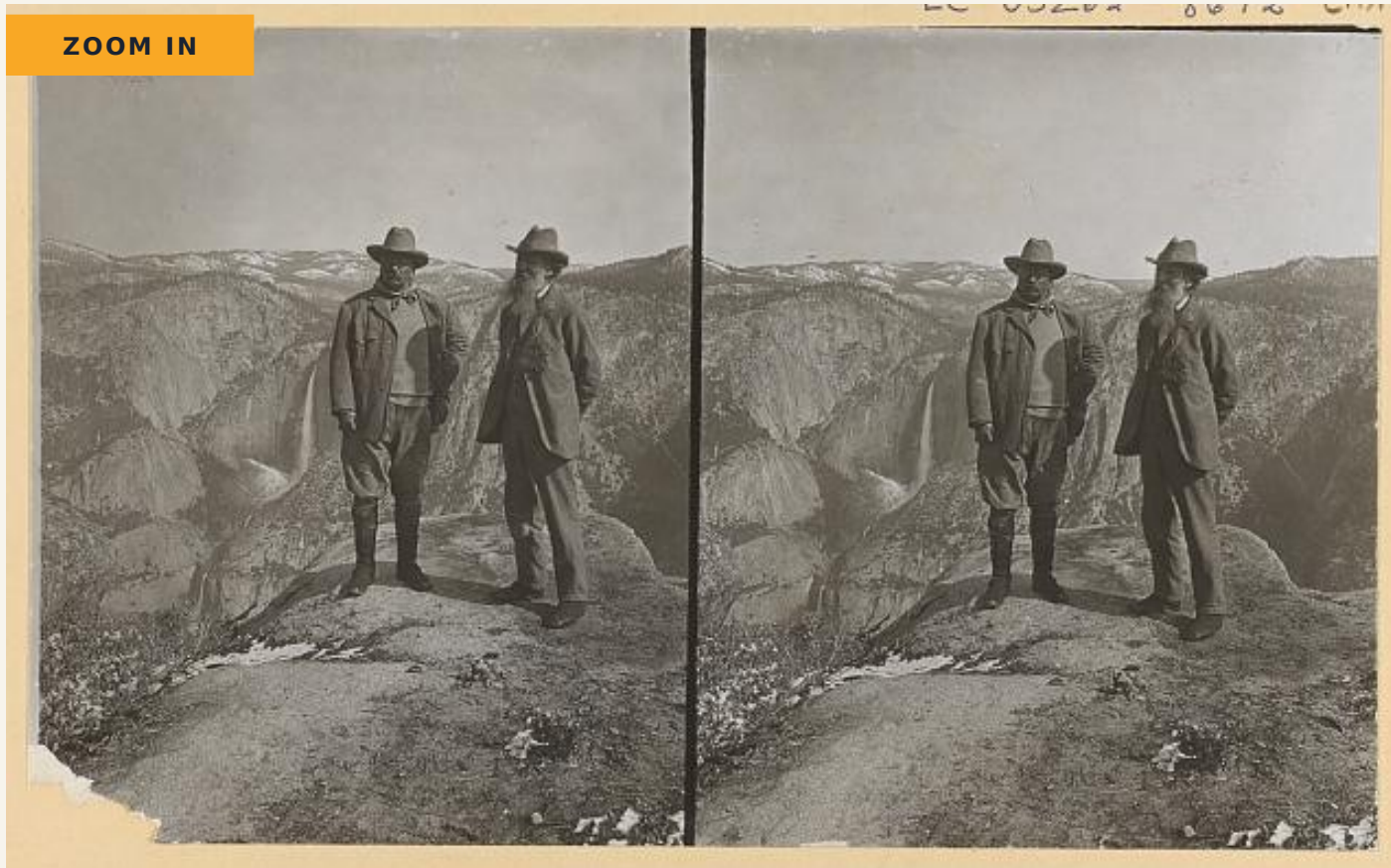
The Federal Reserve Act (1913) created a central banking system to stabilize money and prevent panics like 1907.

ZOOM IN



The National Park Service (1916) unified management of the nation's parks under one federal agency.

ZOOM IN



Read Wilson's message on the Federal Reserve — ask what problem he responds to and who his solution serves.

WHO

Woodrow Wilson — 28th President, speaking to Congress as the chief executive proposing legislation.

WHEN

June 1913, as the Federal Reserve bill was being debated — six years after the Panic of 1907.

WHY

Presidential messages to Congress are public arguments for policy — ask: what problem is he responding to, and who benefits from his proposed solution?

Federal Reserve Act Message

President Woodrow Wilson · 1913

"We shall deal with our economic system as it is and as it may be modified, not as it might be if we had a clean sheet of paper to write upon... We must effect our reforms with a minimum of disturbance to business. The control of the system of banking and of issue should be vested in the Government itself, so that the banks may be the instruments, not the masters, of business."

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.17:

The broader economy gained a more stable banking system; the public gained coordinated stewardship of national parks.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.17:

Private bankers who lost sole control of money and credit; trusts and tariff-protected industries targeted by the New Freedom.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.17:

President Woodrow Wilson working with Congress to pass the Federal Reserve Act and create the National Park Service.

Anchor: Wilson, Federal Reserve Act message, 1913 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

New Freedom

En español: *Nueva Libertad*

WHAT IT MEANS

Woodrow Wilson's Progressive program that targeted the 'triple wall of privilege' — high tariffs, monopolistic banks, and industrial trusts — seeking to restore competition rather than just regulate big business.

Federal Reserve System

En español: *Sistema de la Reserva Federal*

WHAT IT MEANS

The central banking system created by the Federal Reserve Act (1913) — 12 regional banks under a government-appointed board that manages the money supply and stabilizes the financial system.

Underwood Tariff

En español: *Arancel Underwood*

WHAT IT MEANS

Wilson's 1913 tariff reduction that significantly lowered import taxes, making goods cheaper for consumers, while the new income tax (16th Amendment) replaced the lost revenue.

Check your understanding

Analyze how Wilson's reforms created institutional frameworks that continue to influence American economic policy.

- A** Wilson's reforms were all temporary, which does not align with the documented historical record when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- B** The Federal Reserve manages monetary policy, the FTC enforces consumer protection, and the NPS protects natural resources—institutions created over a century ago that remain central to American government today
- C** None of Wilson's institutions survived, which represents a common misconception about the period, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- D** Only the income tax remained from Wilson's era, which does not reflect the consensus among historians when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources and fails to account for key developments in the broader context

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.18

Women's Suffrage Movement

TN STANDARD

US.18 – Describe the movement to achieve suffrage for women, including: the significance of leaders such as Carrie Chapman Catt, Anne Dallas Dudley, and Alice Paul, the activities of suffragettes, the passage of the 19th Amendment, and the role of Tennessee as the 'Perfect 36.'

I CAN

I can describe the movement to achieve suffrage for women, including the significance of leaders such as Carrie Chapman Catt, Anne Dallas Dudley, and Alice Paul, the activities of suffragettes, the passage of the 19th Amendment, and the role of Tennessee as the 'Perfect 36.'

Women had demanded the vote since Seneca Falls (1848); the movement gained new urgency in the Progressive Era.

ZOOM IN



Carrie Chapman Catt led NAWSA's state-by-state "Winning Plan"; Alice Paul pushed militant national tactics; Anne Dallas Dudley organized Tennessee.

ZOOM IN



Suffragists escalated from petitions and lectures to mass parades, picketing the White House, and hunger strikes.

ZOOM IN



US.18 · Suffragette Activities & Tactics

The 19th Amendment passed Congress in 1919; Tennessee's decisive ratification in August 1920 made it the "Perfect 36."

ZOOM IN



US.18 · 19th Amendment & the 'Perfect 36'

Read the 19th Amendment — one sentence that enfranchised millions. Ask who fought for it and what values it enshrined.

WHO

The U.S. Congress and 36 state ratifying bodies — ratified after 70 years of organized suffrage campaigning.

WHEN

August 18, 1920 — the Tennessee vote made it official; it was the final constitutional act of the Progressive Era.

WHY

Constitutional amendments are the highest form of democratic change — understanding who fought for them and why reveals the values a society chose to enshrine in its fundamental law.

19th Amendment

U.S. Constitution · 1920

"The right of citizens of the United States to vote shall not be denied or abridged by the United States or by any State on account of sex. Congress shall have power to enforce this article by appropriate legislation."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.18:

American women, who gained the constitutional right to vote after more than seven decades of organized campaigning.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.18:

Suffragists who endured arrest, hunger strikes, and force-feeding; and many women of color still blocked from voting by Jim Crow after 1920.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.18:

Congress and 36 state legislatures — with Tennessee, the 'Perfect 36,' casting the deciding ratification vote in August 1920.

Anchor: 19th Amendment, 1920 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Women's Suffrage

En español: *Sufragio Femenino*

WHAT IT MEANS

The movement to secure voting rights for women, culminating in the 19th Amendment (1920) after more than 70 years of organized activism.

19th Amendment

En español: *19ª Enmienda*

WHAT IT MEANS

Ratified on August 18, 1920, this amendment prohibits denying any citizen the right to vote based on sex — extending the vote to women across the United States.

Carrie Chapman Catt

En español: *Carrie Chapman Catt*

WHAT IT MEANS

NAWSA president who developed the 'Winning Plan' — a coordinated state-level and federal strategy that led to the 19th Amendment's ratification.

Check your understanding

Analyze the immediate and long-term impacts of women's suffrage on American politics and society.

- A** Women's suffrage had no lasting impact, but the historical record tells a more complex story, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- B** Women stopped participating in politics after 1920, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era
- C** Suffrage immediately enfranchised 26 million women, challenged gender roles, supported reforms in education and health, and laid the foundation for later women's rights movements and gender equality advances
- D** Only electoral politics was affected, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.